

Lai-kine Religion

Lai-kine is a faith-philosophy followed by the vast majority of pahtri, connected particularly to the Laitalu god. The religion is sometimes also called *the path of the dance* given its ecstatic nature.

Gods & Beings

Laitalu

Laitalu, the god of restless moon, also sometimes called the god of the night sky (specifically by zhi).

Seen as a one who created tri and zhi, forming them from their own existence – the light of the moon and stars, and the darkness of night sky.

Monarei Spirits

Concepts

Mirror-Eye

Eyes are portrayed in Lai-kine culture as mirrors – they reflect not the world *as is*, but rather are a reflection of the viewer's inner existence. This is derived from the concept that the moon is the eye of Laitalu, encompassing their power and spirit in pure form. Pahtri however interpret it slightly differently due to stars being part of the equation, particularly dear to them (see “the eye of Laitalu”).

Trivia: the idea for it came from Mildreda's song “Devil's Gaze”, from this part of lyrics: *your eyes were mirrors, for me to see*.

The Eye of Laitalu (Moon)

For tri, the restless moon is seen as the eye of Laitalu god – watching over tri throughout all times. It also symbolises the depths of Laitalu spirit – the power, compassion, wisdom and the dance.

That being said, there's a particular difference on how tris and pahtri consider the eye to be. For the general tri population, it is the *whole* of Laitalu's spirit, including all of its traits.

For pahtri however, it is the *part* of it, with stars being the infinite other. They consider stars and moon as the opposite counterparts – the moon being the spirit of unity and power, the light that guides and protects; while the stars being the spirit of the individual, the infinite of future, the dance and living force.

This distinction makes pahtris see Laitalu as more of a *god of opposites* or *chaotic god*, as opposed to regular tris who see them as a more structured and well-defined force.

Thread of Life

[Basically the journey downwards, from stars to the ground].

The Joyous and Lai-kine

While technically The Joyous and Lai-kine are not synonymous, they are heavily overlapping. The Joyous follow the teachings and philosophy of Lai-kine, with the caveat that Lai-kine is interpreted by them through the hedonistic spirit of Laitalu.

This understanding of Lai-kine is the base of current pahtric tradition seen on Veimos and other lands, but there are other groups that claim to follow the teachings of Lai-kine, diverging from The Joyous path.

Religion in practice

Warrior Dancers

There's a class of warriors among Lai-kine, The Joyous and saphtris that derive from the ecstatic nature of eastern tris culture. Warrior dancers are known for their incredible agility and working upon the body first and foremost. Their appearance on the field resembles one of dancing monks, whirling and stepping between enemies smoothly.

Warrior dancers usually value light armour and weapons, so that they can put the whole focus on moving.